

ENG101 Notes Based on Current Paper Topics

1. Causes and Effects

Understanding causes and effects is essential for explaining events logically in writing and comprehension. A cause explains why something happens, and an effect describes the result of the cause.

Detailed Explanation:

- **Signal Words:** Words like "because," "since," "as a result," "consequently," and "therefore" are often used to connect causes and effects.
- **Why It Matters:** This concept is crucial in essays, especially in analytical or argumentative writing, where explaining the relationship between ideas strengthens your argument.

Examples:

- **Cause:** Heavy rainfall **Effect:** Flooding in the city

Sentence: "The heavy rainfall caused severe flooding in the city."

- **Cause:** Eating too much sugar **Effect:** Increased risk of diabetes

Sentence: "Eating too much sugar increases the risk of developing diabetes."

Writing Exercise:

Write a paragraph explaining the causes and effects of a personal decision you made recently. Include at least two signal words.

2. Clauses

A clause is a fundamental building block of sentences. It consists of a subject and a verb.

Types of Clauses:

- **Independent Clause:** Can stand alone as a sentence.
 - Example: "She enjoys painting."
- **Dependent Clause:** Cannot stand alone and depends on an independent clause to make sense.
 - Example: "Although she enjoys painting."

Combining Clauses:

- **Complex Sentences:** Use subordinating conjunctions (because, although, since, unless) to combine independent and dependent clauses.
 - Example: "She enjoys painting because it helps her relax."

Common Errors:

- Misusing conjunctions or leaving dependent clauses incomplete.
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3. Fragments (Identifying and Fixing Incomplete Sentences)

Fragments lack a subject, verb, or complete thought, leading to confusion.

Detailed Steps to Identify Fragments:

1. Check if the group of words has both a subject and a verb.
2. Ensure it conveys a complete idea.

Fixing Fragments:

- **Add Missing Elements:** "Running late for school" becomes "She was running late for school."
- **Combine with a Complete Sentence:** "Because it was raining" becomes "I stayed inside because it was raining."

Practice:

Identify and rewrite these fragments into complete sentences:

1. "Before the sun sets."
 2. "Walking to the park."
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4. Sentence Types

Understanding sentence types is essential for crafting varied and engaging writing.

Types and Structures:

- **Simple Sentence:** Contains one independent clause.
 - Example: "I enjoy reading."
- **Compound Sentence:** Contains two or more independent clauses joined by a coordinating conjunction (and, but, or).
 - Example: "I enjoy reading, and I also love writing."
- **Complex Sentence:** Contains one independent clause and at least one dependent clause.
 - Example: "Although I was tired, I completed the assignment."
- **Compound-Complex Sentence:** Contains two or more independent clauses and at least one dependent clause.
 - Example: "I stayed up late because I had homework, but I finished it on time."

Practice:

Write one sentence of each type about your favorite hobby.

5. Tenses

Tenses show the time of an action or event and are critical for maintaining clarity in writing.

Detailed Explanation of Tenses:

- **Present Tense:** Describes actions happening now or habitual actions.
 - Example: "She walks to school every day."
- **Past Tense:** Describes actions that have already happened.
 - Example: "She walked to school yesterday."
- **Future Tense:** Describes actions that will happen.
 - Example: "She will walk to school tomorrow."

Advanced Tips:

- Use perfect tenses for more precise time relationships.
 - Example: "She has walked to school for years."

Exercise:

Convert the following sentence into all three tenses:

- "She studies math."

6. Essay and Paragraph Writing

Effective writing starts with understanding structure and purpose.

Paragraph Structure:

1. **Topic Sentence:** States the main idea.
2. **Supporting Details:** Provide evidence, examples, and explanations.
3. **Concluding Sentence:** Summarizes the paragraph or transitions to the next idea.

Essay Structure:

- **Introduction:** Introduce the topic and provide a thesis statement.
- **Body Paragraphs:** Present main arguments or ideas with supporting evidence.
- **Conclusion:** Summarize the key points and restate the thesis.

Tip:

Use outlines to organize your ideas before writing.

7. Parallelism

Parallelism ensures grammatical consistency in sentences, improving clarity and readability.

Examples:

- **Correct:** "She likes swimming, biking, and running."
- **Incorrect:** "She likes swimming, biking, and to run."

Exercise:

Rewrite these sentences for parallelism:

1. "He enjoys hiking, to swim, and biking."
 2. "The company values hard work, being punctual, and honesty."
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8. Functional Words

Functional words include articles, prepositions, and conjunctions that structure sentences.

Example:

- **Articles:** "A book," "An apple," "The car"
- **Prepositions:** "In the house," "On the table"
- **Conjunctions:** "He studied hard, but he didn't pass."

Practice:

Write a sentence using at least two functional words.

9. Synonyms and Antonyms

- **Synonyms:** Words with similar meanings. Example: Happy – Joyful.
- **Antonyms:** Words with opposite meanings. Example: Happy – Sad.

Exercise:

Find two synonyms and two antonyms for the word "bright."

10. Coherence and Emphasis

- **Coherence:** Logical flow of ideas in writing. Use transition words (however, therefore, in addition).
- **Emphasis:** Place important points at the beginning or end of a sentence for greater impact.

Example:

- **Coherence:** "She was late; therefore, she missed the bus."
- **Emphasis:** "The most critical factor is time management."

11. Orders in Sentences

Sentence order affects clarity. Use chronological, spatial, or logical orders based on context.

- Example: "Close the door before you leave."

12. Prepositions

Prepositions connect nouns or pronouns to other words, showing relationships.

Common Uses:

- Time: "We met on Monday."
- Place: "The keys are under the mat."

Exercise:

Correct this sentence: "He is good in mathematics."

13. Spelling Correction

Focus on commonly misspelled words and their correct forms.

- Example:
 - Incorrect: "Recieve"
 - Correct: "Receive"

14. Passive and Active Voice

- **Active Voice:** The subject performs the action.
 - Example: "She completed the project."
- **Passive Voice:** The subject receives the action.
 - Example: "The project was completed by her."

Tip:

Use active voice for directness and passive voice for formality or emphasis on the object.

Suggested YouTube Videos:

1. **Causes and Effects:**
 - "Cause and Effect Writing" by Oxford Online English
2. **Clauses:**

- "Types of Clauses" by Learn English Lab

3. **Sentence Types:**

- "Simple, Compound, and Complex Sentences" by Grammar Spot

4. **Tenses:**

- "12 English Tenses" by English Addict with Mr Steve

5. **Passive and Active Voice:**

- "Active vs Passive Voice" by English with Lucy

6. **Essay Writing:**

- "How to Write Essays" by Emma (Learn English with Emma)

By mastering these topics and practicing regularly, you'll strengthen your command of English grammar and writing skills. Make sure to complement this guide with handouts and lecture notes for thorough preparation.